

ສາທາລະນະລັດ ປະຊາທິປະໄຕ ປະຊາຊົນລາວ
ສັນຕິພາບ ເອກະລາດ ປະຊາທິປະໄຕ ເອກະພາບ ວັດທະນະຖາວອນ

Lao People's Democratic Republic — Peace Independence Democracy Unity Prosperity

ກະຊວງສຶກສາທິການ ແລະ ກິລາ
Ministry of Education and Sports

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

ການແຈ້ງເຕືອນໄພນໍ້າຖ້ວມ
ແລະ ການໂຈະການຮຽນການສອນຢູ່ໂຮງຮຽນ
Flood Early Warning and
Suspension of Classes in Schools

Reference: MoES/SOP/DRR/01 (number assigned on issuance)
Instrument: Ministerial Decision (ຂໍ້ຕົກລົງ) establishing standing procedure
Issuing authority: Minister of Education and Sports
Legal basis: Law on Disaster Management No. 71/NA (2019), Arts. 18, 52, 54; Law on Education
Applies to: All education institutions, all levels, all 18 provinces
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Draft for Ministerial Consideration

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From field research conducted in Luang Namtha Province following the flooding of 29–31 August 2026
11 respondents across 7 schools and 2 districts · all participants consented to the use of this data
September 2026

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How to read this document

If you are a...	Read first	Then keep
School principal	Part 4 (Suspension decision); Annex C	Annex C laminated in your office
Teacher	Annex D (Classroom actions)	Annex D inside your class register
DESB officer	Part 3 (Warning receipt); Part 8 (Reporting)	Annex E; Form SOP-08
PESS officer	Part 8; Part 9 (LESMIS)	Annex F
MoES central	Part 1; Part 9; Part 10	The whole document

PART I

ຈຸດປະສົງ, ຂອບເຂດ ແລະ ພື້ນຖານທາງກົດໝາຍ
Purpose, Scope and Legal Basis

1.1 ຈຸດປະສົງ — Purpose

ຂັ້ນຕອນນີ້ ກຳນົດວິທີການທີ່ຊັດເຈນ ສຳລັບການຮັບຄຳເຕືອນໄພນ້ຳຖ້ວມ, ການຕັດສິນໃຈໃຈການຮຽນການສອນ, ການເປີດໂຮງຮຽນຄືນ ແລະ ການບັນທຶກເຫດການ ເພື່ອໃຫ້ທຸກໂຮງຮຽນປະຕິບັດຄືກັນ ແລະ ເພື່ອໃຫ້ການຕັດສິນໃຈ ບົກບ້ອງນັກຮຽນ ມີຜົນບັງຄັບທາງກົດໝາຍ ແລະ ຖືກບັນທຶກໄວ້ຢ່າງເປັນລະບົບ.

This Standard Operating Procedure establishes a single, uniform procedure by which:

1. A flood warning **reaches** a named, accountable person at every school;
2. A decision to **suspend classes** is made lawfully, quickly, and on stated criteria;
3. Children are **protected** during the suspension;
4. The school **reopens** on stated criteria;
5. The event is **recorded** in the national education information system, so that lost instructional time can be measured and recovered.

1.2 ບັນຫາທີ່ຂັ້ນຕອນນີ້ແກ້ໄຂ — The problem this SOP solves

Field research in Luang Namtha Province following the flooding of 29–31 August 2026 established four specific failures. Every substantive clause of this SOP exists to correct one of them.

#	Observed failure	Evidence	Corrected by
F1	Warnings reached most schools through personal social media and chat groups, not through any official channel bearing a named sender	5 of 5 school-level respondents; 2 of 4 principals	Part 3 — designated Warning Focal Point; mandatory acknowledgement
F2	Principals suspended classes on their own authority, with no written instrument authorising them to do so	4 of 4 principals stated they decided themselves; one sought permission and waited while water rose	§4.2 — standing pre-authorisation
F3	Closure was recorded nowhere, or on paper only. Nothing entered LESMIS	"It was not recorded anywhere"; both DESB offices: "recorded on paper only"; 0 of 4 principals knew of any closure form	Part 9 — LESMIS fields L1–L15
F4	Lost instructional days were not recovered, because no authority had issued a recovery instruction	Teachers reported waiting; 4–21 days lost per school, unrecovered two weeks after the event	Part 7 — automatic recovery obligation

1.3 ຫຼັກຖານສຳຄັນ: ເຫດການດຽວກັນ, ສອງເມືອງ, ສອງຜົນ — The decisive evidence: one flood, two districts, two outcomes

The August 2026 flood struck schools in two districts of one province within the same forty-eight hours. The institutional response differed almost entirely — and so did the result.

	Nalae district	Luang Namtha district
DESB on the official warning distribution list	Yes	No
Officer designated to receive warnings	Yes — "a formally designated duty assigned to a specific officer"	No — "it depends on whoever sees or hears the warning first"
Non-responders followed up	Yes — "confirmation required, and we follow up non-responders"	No — "confirmation expected, but not systematically followed up"
Schools receiving a written warning	2 of 2	0 of 4
Warning carried a named issuing authority	2 of 2	0 of 4
Receipt acknowledged by the school	2 of 2	0 of 4
Lead time achieved	5 hours; 48 hours	~6 hours; 15–20 minutes
Mean instructional days lost	3.5	~14

School 032, Nalae district — the positive case. This school received a telephone call from the DESB at 08:00 carrying a written warning issued in the name of the **District Disaster Management Committee**, instructing schools to move belongings to high ground. The deputy principal confirmed receipt and had **five hours**. The school held a written flood plan naming who to telephone, and a designated safety focal person. It moved equipment to an upper floor. Floodwater reached the perimeter fence and kitchen garden but not the buildings. The school **did not suspend classes**, lost **no instructional days**, lost no pupils, and afterwards sent a written report to the DESB.

School 032 sits **30 metres from a watercourse**. It is not the least exposed school in the sample. It is the best prepared.

NOTE TO THE MINISTRY

Every element this SOP requires was already in place at School 032 in August 2026. **This document does not import a foreign model. It makes national policy out of what one Lao district was already doing.** Both districts, however, score zero on legal mandate — Nalae's good practice was built despite the absence of an instrument, by officers who chose to work that way. It therefore depends on individuals and will not survive their transfer. Converting it into a standing procedure is the purpose of this SOP.

1.4 280UC20 — Scope

In scope: riverine flooding, flash flooding, dam or reservoir release, and landslide triggered by the same rainfall event, where these affect the safety of pupils, staff, school buildings, or the journey to and from school.

Out of scope: fire, epidemic disease, civil disturbance, and structural failure unrelated to water. Parallel procedures are required for these — see §10.4, Action 8.

Geographic application: all provinces. Districts classified Tier A or Tier B under Annex A shall complete the full preparedness cycle in Part 2. Tier C districts complete §§2.1, 2.2, 2.3 and 2.6 only.

1.5 ພື້ນຖານທາງກົດໝາຍ ແລະ ບັນຫາເລື່ອງອຳນາດ — Legal basis and the authority problem

1.5.1 What the law presently provides

Instrument	Provision	Effect
Law on Disaster Management No. 71/NA (2019), Art. 18	Authority to issue a warning rests with the head of the territorial administration — district, provincial or national — according to the scale of the event	DMH forecasts; it does not warn. Only the territorial administrative head warns.
Same law, Art. 52	Ministries may establish sector disaster management committees	Permissive, not mandatory. MoES has not established one.
Same law, Art. 54	Composition of District Disaster Management Committees	Provides the seat through which education enters district disaster governance
Law on Education	Places responsibility for the safety and welfare of pupils on the school administration	Creates a duty of care, but names no trigger, threshold or procedure

1.5.2 The gap

Article 18 creates an **issuing** authority. It does not create a **receiving** duty. No instrument requires that a warning issued by a district head be transmitted to, acknowledged by, or acted upon by a school. Nor does any instrument authorise a principal to suspend classes.

The consequence observed in the field: principals acted without authority. They were right to act — children were protected — but they carried personal legal exposure for a decision the State had not empowered them to make, and the State acquired no record that the decision had been taken.

1.5.3 How this SOP closes the gap without amending the law

This SOP does not purport to alter Article 18. It operates within it, by three devices.

(a) Standing pre-authorisation. The Minister, exercising ordinary powers of direction over education institutions, pre-authorises principals to suspend classes on the defined objective triggers at §4.3. Authority is delegated in advance and in writing, so that at the moment of decision the principal acts *under* instruction rather than in its absence.

(b) Reverse reporting. Because authority is delegated in advance, the information flow reverses: the principal notifies the DESB *after* acting, within two hours (§4.7), rather than seeking permission before acting. This removes the delay that trapped one respondent, who "needed permission" while water was rising.

(c) Designated receipt. MoES designates the DESB as the education sector's receiving point for warnings issued under Article 18 (§3.2), and requires the DESB to relay to schools with acknowledgement (§3.5). This creates the receiving duty that Article 18 omits.

RECOMMENDATION

Devices (a) to (c) may be enacted by ministerial decision alone. Establishing the sector committee under Article 52 (§10.2) would place this SOP on firmer statutory footing and is recommended within twelve months of issuance.

1.6 ນິຍາມ — Definitions

Term	Lao	Meaning in this SOP
Forecast	ການພະຍາກອນ	A statement by DMH of expected meteorological or hydrological conditions. Carries no instruction.
Warning	ຄໍາເຕືອນໄພ	An instruction issued under Art. 18 by a territorial administrative head. Carries authority.
Alert level	ລະດັບການເຕືອນໄພ	One of the five levels defined at §3.1
Suspension of classes	ການໂຈະການຮຽນການສອນ	Temporary cessation of teaching; the school remains an institution. Not dissolution (ຍຸບ).
Closure day	ມື້ທີ່ໂຈະການສອນ	A scheduled instructional day on which teaching did not occur by reason of flood
Warning Focal Point	ຜູ້ຮັບຜິດຊອບການເຕືອນໄພ	The named officer at each level who receives, acknowledges and relays warnings
Safe Assembly Point	ຈຸດລວມຕົວປອດໄພ	Pre-identified location above modelled flood level, reachable on foot
Catchment journey time	ເວລາເດີນທາງ	Time for a pupil from the farthest served village to reach home on foot
Trigger	ເງື່ອນໄຂ	An objective, observable condition compelling a defined action without further discretion

PART 2

ການກຽມພ້ອມ — ວົງຈອນປະຈຳປີ

Preparedness — Annual Cycle

Timing: to be completed before 1 May each year.

EVIDENTIARY BASIS

Not one of the eleven respondents had received disaster training. Not one school held flood drills. Preparedness is where this SOP is cheapest to implement and where it will produce the largest effect.

2.1 ການຕັ້ງຜູ້ຮັບຜິດຊອບການເຕືອນໄພ — Appointment of the Warning Focal Point

Every school shall designate, in writing, by name and mobile number:

Role	Who	Duty
Primary WFP	The principal	Receives warnings; decides suspension
Alternate WFP	Deputy principal or senior teacher	Acts when the primary is unreachable within 15 minutes
Second alternate	Any permanent staff member	Acts when both of the above are unreachable

The three names shall be lodged with the DESB by **30 April**, and updated within seven days of any change.

WHY THREE

In the August 2026 event one principal was at home, one was teaching at a different school, and one learned of the flood from a parent. A single point of contact fails.

2.2 ການປະເມີນຄວາມສ່ຽງນ້ຳຖ້ວມຂອງໂຮງຮຽນ — School Flood Risk Assessment

Each school completes **Form SOP-01** (Annex B) annually, recording:

1. Distance from the nearest watercourse, in metres (one Luang Namtha school recorded 1 m)
2. Elevation of the lowest classroom floor above normal water level
3. Whether the site has flooded before, and in which years
4. Which parts flood first — classrooms, dormitory, kitchen, latrines, access road
5. Number of pupils resident in dormitories, by floor
6. Number of villages served, and journey time from the farthest (one school: 14 villages, farthest 19 km)
7. Whether any pupil's route home crosses a watercourse or a ford
8. Location and capacity of the Safe Assembly Point
9. Whether the school is designated as a community evacuation shelter

The completed form determines the school's **Exposure Tier** under Annex A.

2.3 ບັນຊີຕົວຕໍ່ — Contact tree

The DESB shall hold, and verify **quarterly**:

- The three WFP names and mobile numbers for every school in the district
- At least one alternative channel per school — chat group, village loudspeaker, or the village head's number
- A written record of the date each number was last tested

PRESERVING EXISTING GOOD PRACTICE

Both DESB offices reported holding contact lists that are "regularly updated" — the strongest single element found anywhere in the chain. This clause formalises what already works.

2.4 ການຝຶກຊ້ອມ — Drills

Drill	Frequency	Participants	Record
Warning cascade test	Twice yearly (April, August)	DESB → all schools; WFPs acknowledge	Form SOP-08
Evacuation to Assembly Point	Once yearly, before 1 June	All pupils and staff	Form SOP-02
Dormitory night evacuation	Once yearly (boarding schools)	Resident pupils, wardens	Form SOP-02
Tabletop exercise	Once yearly	Principals, DESB, District DM Committee	Minutes

The evacuation drill shall be **timed**. The interval from alarm to the last pupil reaching the Assembly Point shall be recorded and reported. **Where that time exceeds the shortest credible warning lead time for the district, the school shall report this to the DESB as a capability gap.**

EVIDENCE AND LITERATURE

Zero of eleven respondents had participated in a flood drill; one recalled a fire drill. Agent-based validation of a school evacuation drill in a tsunami inundation zone achieved 5.9% error against measured evacuation time, demonstrating that timed drills yield planning-grade data. Modelling also indicates that timely warnings *coupled with training* substantially improve response outcomes, whereas warnings alone may not.

2.5 ແຜນຮັບມົນລະພິດຂອງໂຮງຮຽນ — Written school flood plan

Each Tier A and Tier B school shall hold a one-page plan (Form SOP-03) stating: the three WFP names and numbers; the trigger table from §4.3 reproduced verbatim; the Assembly Point and route; which staff member accounts for which class; arrangements for pupils who cannot be collected; arrangements for dormitory residents; where equipment and records are moved and by whom; and the DESB, District DM Committee and village authority numbers.

The plan shall be posted in the principal's office and the staff room, and issued to every teacher.

EVIDENCE

School 032 — the school that lost no instructional days — held exactly such a plan, and confirmed that it named floods specifically and stated who to telephone. Two of four principals held no plan at all.

2.6 ການຝຶກອົບຮົມ — Training

Audience	Content	Duration	Frequency
Principals and WFPs	This SOP in full; triggers; reporting	1 day	On issuance, then annually
All teachers	Annex D; assembly; accounting for pupils	2 hours	Annually, at term start
DESB officers	Parts 3, 8 and 9; LESMIS entry	1 day	On issuance, then annually
Pupils	What the alarm means; where to go; never to cross water	30 min	Each term

2.7 ການກຽມລ່ວງໜ້າ — Pre-positioning

Before 1 May, Tier A schools shall: move records and electronic equipment above the highest recorded flood level or to a designated upper room; confirm the Assembly Point route is passable; confirm the alarm is audible in every classroom and dormitory; and confirm that at least one staff member on site holds a charged mobile telephone with credit.

PART 3

ການເຝົ້າລະວັງ ແລະ ການຮັບຄຳເຕືອນໄພ
Watch and Warning Receipt

3.1 ລະດັບການເຕືອນໄພ — Alert levels

The following five levels apply nationally. They are designed so that a school may act on thirty minutes' notice or on forty-eight hours' notice using the same framework.

Level	Trigger	Lead time	Required action
0 — SEASONAL WATCH ເຝົ້າລະວັງຕາມລະດູ	Rainy season in progress (approx. 1 May – 31 Oct)	Continuous	Preparedness complete; WFP contactable
1 — ADVISORY ແຈ້ງເຕືອນ	DMH forecast of heavy rain affecting the district	24–72 h	WFP monitors; principal reviews plan; pre- position equipment
2 — ALERT ເຝົ້າລະວັງສູງ	DMH flood watch; upstream river rising; or dam release notified	6–24 h	Notify parents of the possibility; confirm transport; prepare early release; brief staff
3 — WARNING ເຕືອນໄພ	Art. 18 warning issued, or any trigger at §4.3 met	1–6 h	Suspension decision taken. Pupils released, or moved to the Assembly Point
4 — EMERGENCY ສຸກເສີນ	Water entering the site; access road cut; or less than 1 hour	<1 h	Immediate move to the Assembly Point. Do not release pupils onto flooded routes

Critical design point. In the August 2026 event one school had fifteen to twenty minutes between warning and water. A system functioning only at twenty-four hours' notice would have failed that school entirely. Level 4 exists for that case, and its first instruction is the *opposite* of Level 3's: **do not send children out.**

3.2 ຜູ້ຮັບຄຳເຕືອນໄພ — Who receives the warning

MoES hereby designates, for the purposes of the education sector:

Level	Designated receiving body	Named officer
National	MoES, Department of Planning	Director, or designated WFP
Provincial	PESS	Deputy Head, or designated WFP
District	DESB	Deputy Head of DESB (Art. 54 seat)
School	School	Primary WFP (the principal)

The DESB Deputy Head, holding the education seat on the District Disaster Management Committee under Article 54, is the **single designated receiving point** for Article 18 warnings affecting schools in the district.

EVIDENCE

Of the two DESB offices interviewed, one confirmed it was on the official distribution list and that receipt was "a formally designated duty assigned to a specific officer." The other stated it was **not** on the list, and that receipt depended on "whoever sees or hears the warning first." Schools served by the first office lost 0 and 7 instructional days; those served by the second lost 4, 15, 15 and approximately 21. **This clause makes the first office's practice the national standard.**

3.3 ການຂໍຂ້າລາຍຊື່ຜູ້ຮັບການເຕືອນໄພ — Standing request to territorial administrations

MoES shall write to each Provincial Governor and District Chief requesting that the DESB Deputy Head be added to the standing distribution list for all warnings issued under Article 18, and that each warning state: the issuing authority by name and title; the hazard, area affected and expected time of impact; whether schools are specifically instructed to suspend classes; and a contact number for confirmation.

NOTE

This is a request, not a direction — district administrations do not report to MoES. Where a district declines, the triggers at §4.3 still authorise the principal to act on observable conditions alone. **The SOP does not depend on the request succeeding.** This is deliberate: a procedure that fails when another ministry does not cooperate is not a procedure.

3.4 ໜ້າທີ່ຂອງຫ້ອງການສຶກສາເມືອງເມື່ອໄດ້ຮັບຄຳເຕືອນ — What the DESB does on receipt

Within **thirty minutes** of receiving a warning at Level 2 or above, the DESB WFP shall:

1. Record receipt in the Cascade Log (Form SOP-08): time, source, level, text
2. Identify affected schools from the district risk register (Annex A), Tier A first
3. Transmit to every affected school by **two independent channels** — telephone call *and* group message
4. Record each school's acknowledgement
5. At 60 minutes, telephone any school that has not acknowledged
6. At 90 minutes, contact the village authority for any school still unreachable
7. At 120 minutes, report unreachable schools to the District DM Committee and request physical dispatch

EVIDENCE

One DESB reported contacting all principals within 30 minutes; the other within 2 hours. One required confirmation and followed up non-responders; the other expected confirmation but did not systematically pursue it. The 30/60/90/120 ladder makes the stronger practice the standard.

3.5 ການຍືນຍັນການໄດ້ຮັບ ເປັນການບັງຄັບ — Acknowledgement is mandatory

A warning is **not** deemed delivered until the school WFP has acknowledged it. The acknowledgement shall state: *school name, WFP name, time received, action being taken*. Silence is treated as non-delivery and escalated under §3.4, steps 5 to 7. A school that has not acknowledged is treated as **not warned**, and its pupils as **unprotected**, until contact is confirmed.

THEORETICAL BASIS

The Protective Action Decision Model identifies three critical predecision processes — **reception, attention and comprehension** — which precede all further processing. Nothing downstream of reception can occur if reception fails. This SOP therefore instruments reception explicitly rather than assuming it. In the field, the two schools that acknowledged receipt lost 0 and 7 days; the four that did not lost 4, 15, 15 and approximately 21.

3.6 ຊ່ອງທາງການສື່ສານ — Channels, in order of reliability

Rank	Channel	Use	Limitation
1	Telephone call, person to person	Levels 3–4	Slow across many schools
2	Group message with named sender	Levels 1–3	Requires signal; may be missed
3	Village loudspeaker	Levels 3–4	Reaches pupils and parents as well
4	Radio broadcast	Levels 2–4, wide area	No targeting, no acknowledgement
5	Messenger on foot or motorcycle	Level 4, signal failure	Last resort

At Levels 3 and 4, **channels 1 and 2 shall both be used**. No warning at Level 3 or above may rely on a group message alone.

LITERATURE

Research on local flood governance documents "shadow systems" in which local officials construct informal interpretive practices to bridge the gap between generic national alerts and operational need. The chat groups observed in Luang Namtha are precisely such a system. The correct response is not to abolish them — they carried information faster than any official channel — but to give them standing, a named sender, and an acknowledgement requirement, converting an informal workaround into an accountable channel.

PART 4

ການຕັດສິນໃຈໄລ່ການຮຽນການສອນ

The Suspension Decision

4.1 ໃຜເປັນຜູ້ຕັດສິນໃຈ — Who decides

Situation	Decision-maker
Art. 18 warning received naming schools	The warning is executed; the principal implements
Art. 18 warning received, schools not named	Principal , applying §4.3
No warning received, a §4.3 trigger is met	Principal , under standing pre-authorisation
Principal and both alternates unreachable	The most senior staff member on site
Multiple schools, district-wide event	DESB may direct district-wide suspension

4.2 ການມອບອຳນາດລ່ວງໜ້າ — Standing pre-authorisation

Section 4.3 constitutes a standing written instruction from the Minister of Education and Sports.

A principal who suspends classes in accordance with §4.3 acts **under** ministerial authority, not in its absence. No prior permission is required from the DESB, PESS or MoES.

No disciplinary or financial consequence shall attach to a suspension properly made under §4.3, **including where the flood does not subsequently materialise.**

WHY THE FINAL CLAUSE MATTERS

Fear of being wrong is the principal reason officials delay protective decisions. A principal who suspends and is not flooded must be as safe as one who suspends and is. Without this clause the trigger table will be under-used, and the SOP will fail in exactly the cases it exists to address.

4.3 ເງື່ອນໄຂການໄລ່ການຮຽນການສອນ — Triggers

Suspension is **required**, without further consultation, where **any one** of the following is true:

Code	Condition
Group A — Warning-based	
A1	An Art. 18 warning names the school, the village, or "all schools" in the area
A2	The DESB instructs suspension
A3	DMH issues a flood warning for a watercourse within 500 m of the school
Group B — Observation-based	
B1	Water is inside any school building
B2	Water is across the access road, or across any route pupils use to reach home
B3	The watercourse has risen to a level that, in local experience, precedes flooding of the site
B4	A ford or footbridge on any pupil's route is impassable or judged unsafe
Group C — Upstream-based	
C1	A dam or reservoir release upstream has been notified
C2	An upstream village or school reports flooding on the same watercourse
C3	A landslide has blocked a watercourse upstream
Group D — Capacity-based	
D1	The school cannot account for all pupils and staff
D2	Power and water have failed and are not expected to return within the school day
D3	Sanitation has been contaminated or is inaccessible
D4	Fewer than half the teaching staff can reach the school

EVIDENCE

Every principal interviewed decided on some combination of B3, C1 and past experience — but each weighted them differently, and none could point to a written criterion. Group C reflects a concern raised unprompted by two respondents: both wanted to know **when dams would release water**.

4.4 ຮູບແບບການໄລ່ — What suspension means

Decision	When	Effect
Do not open	Before the school day begins	Pupils do not travel. Preferred where lead time allows.
Early release	During the school day, routes still passable	Pupils sent home in supervised groups
Shelter in place	Routes unsafe; site safe	Pupils held at school until collected
Evacuate to Assembly Point	Site unsafe	All move to higher ground; register taken on arrival

Decision rule at Level 4. Where water is already on the routes, **shelter in place or evacuate to the Assembly Point. Do not release pupils.** More children drown travelling through floodwater than in buildings.

4.5 ການບັນທຶກການຕັດສິນໃຈ — The decision must be recorded when it is made

Before acting, or immediately afterwards, the principal completes **Form SOP-04**: date, time, alert level, trigger codes applied, decision, who was informed and when, pupils on site, pupils unaccounted for, and condition of the site.

Form SOP-04 is the **source record** for all subsequent reporting. One sheet per event. Retained for five years.

This single form is the intervention that closes failure F3. Without a contemporaneous record the closure cannot enter LESMIS, cannot be aggregated, and cannot be recovered against.

4.6 ການແຈ້ງຄູ, ນັກຮຽນ ແລະ ຜູ້ປົກຄອງ — Informing teachers, pupils and parents

Audience	Channel	Content	Timing
Teachers	Staff group, then verbal	Level, action, class assignment	Immediate
Pupils	Teacher, in class	What is happening, where to go, what to carry	Immediate
Parents	School group; village loudspeaker; village head	School suspended; collection arrangements; do not send children	Within 30 min
Village authority	Telephone	Suspension; pupils travelling; assistance needed	Within 30 min

Standard message texts are at **Annex G**. Use them verbatim; do not compose new wording under pressure.

THEORETICAL BASIS

Contextual testing of PADM across four intervals found that perceptions of **protective action** and of **stakeholder norms** — but *not* threat perception — predicted protective action decisions. People act when they know what the protective action is and who is expected to take it. Pre-written messages and named roles supply exactly those two predictors.

4.7 ການລາຍງານຫຼັງການຕັດສິນໃຈ — Reverse reporting: notify the DESB within two hours

The principal shall notify the DESB **within two hours** of suspending, by telephone, and transmit Form SOP-04 within twenty-four hours.

This is **notification, not application**. The principal does not wait for a reply.

EVIDENCE

One of four principals stated they "needed permission" and consulted before acting. Reverse reporting removes that delay while preserving district oversight.

PART 5

ໃນລະຫວ່າງການໄລ່ການສອນ

During the Suspension

5.1 ການນັບນັກຮຽນ — Accounting for pupils

- Class teachers account for their own class and report to the principal **by name, not by number**
- Any pupil unaccounted for is reported to the DESB and the village authority **immediately**, not at the end of the day
- Dormitory wardens account separately for resident pupils
- A pupil who cannot be collected **remains in the care of the school** until collected or placed with the village authority. **No pupil is released alone.**

EVIDENCE

One school reported that the flood struck during preparation for the new term, when parents were on site building dormitory accommodation and could not return home. Schools must plan for adults stranded on site as well as pupils.

5.2 ການບັນທຶກການເຂົ້າຮຽນ — Attendance recording during suspension

Suspension days shall be recorded, not left blank. Each closure day is marked in the class register with the code ຖ້ວມ / FLD, and counted as a **closure day**, not an absence.

EVIDENCE

Asked whether attendance was recorded on closure days, respondents answered "not recorded on the closure days." A blank register is indistinguishable from a lost register. The FLD code makes lost instructional time countable — the precondition for recovering it.

5.3 ການປົກປ້ອງສະຖານທີ່ — Site protection

Where safe, and only where safe, move records, equipment and teaching materials above expected water level. **No staff member shall enter floodwater to retrieve property.**

5.4 ລາຍງານປະຈຳວັນ — Daily situation report

For suspensions exceeding one day, the principal reports daily to the DESB by telephone: water level trend, site condition, staff and pupils accounted for, estimated reopening, urgent needs. The DESB consolidates and reports daily to PESS, which reports to MoES **when three or more schools in a province are suspended.**

PART 6

ການເປີດໂຮງຮຽນຄືນ
Reopening

6.1 ໃຜເປັນຜູ້ຕັດສິນໃຈ — Who decides

The **principal** decides, applying §6.2, after inspection. The DESB is notified. Where a building is structurally suspect, the DESB shall arrange technical inspection before reoccupation.

6.2 ເງື່ອນໄຂການເປີດຄືນ — Reopening criteria: all must be satisfied

#	Criterion	Verified by
R1	Water has receded from all buildings and the site	Principal, visual
R2	Access routes passable for the farthest-travelling pupil	Principal + village authority
R3	Structure shows no sign of undermining, cracking or collapse	Principal; DESB technical if in doubt
R4	Latrines functioning and not contaminated	Principal
R5	Drinking water safe, or an alternative supply in place	Principal
R6	Electrical installations inspected before re-energising	Qualified person
R7	Silt, debris and contamination cleared from teaching spaces	Principal
R8	Snakes, insects and animal hazards cleared	Principal
R9	Sufficient teaching staff able to attend	Principal
R10	No further warning in force	Principal, via DESB

EVIDENCE

One principal reported that reopening was decided by the school committee "based on the cleaning being completed"; another cited "the receding water conditions." Criteria R1–R10 make that judgement explicit and auditable. UNICEF supported cleaning and supplies in the August 2026 response — R7 records that dependency so that it can be planned rather than improvised.

6.3 ການເປີດຄືນເປັນໄລຍະ — Phased reopening

Where some facilities are usable, the school may reopen in part: day pupils before boarders; upper floors before ground floors; morning-only sessions where water or sanitation is limited. Phased reopening shall be recorded in LESMIS as **partial operation**, not as full reopening.

6.4 ການບັນທຶກການເປີດຄືນ — Record the reopening

Form SOP-05: date of reopening; criteria met; criteria waived and why; pupils returning against enrolled; pupils not returned; facilities not restored; support received and from whom.

PART 7

ການຊົດເຊີຍເວລາຮຽນທີ່ຂາດໄປ

Recovery of Lost Instructional Time

This Part exists because of failure F4. It is the clause teachers asked for.

7.1 ເງື່ອນໄຂອັດຕະໂນມັດ — Automatic trigger: no order required

On reopening, the recovery obligation arises automatically. The school does **not** wait for an instruction from the DESB, PESS or MoES.

Closure days lost	Required response	Approval
1–2 days	Absorb within the existing scheme of work	None
3–5 days	School recovery plan (Form SOP-06) within 10 days	Notify DESB
6–10 days	School recovery plan; DESB endorsement	DESB within 10 days
11+ days	School plan; PESS endorsement; MoES notified	PESS within 15 days
Examination year affected	Immediate referral	PESS and MoES

EVIDENCE

Teachers stated that lost days were "not made up until DESB issue any order for further makeup of class," and no such order had arrived two weeks after the event. One principal recorded plainly that "nothing was done to make up the time." Schools lost between 4 and 21 days. Making the obligation automatic removes dependence on a discretionary instruction that, in the observed case, never came.

7.2 ວິທີການຊົດເຊີຍ — Permitted recovery methods

1. Extension of the school day (maximum one additional hour; not for pupils travelling more than one hour)
2. Saturday sessions (maximum four per term)
3. Shortening of a scheduled break
4. Syllabus compression, with **documented** prioritisation of learning outcomes
5. Assigned home study with teacher follow-up
6. Extension of the academic term (PESS approval required)

NOTE ON METHOD 4

Two of four principals held make-up classes; one compressed the syllabus; one did nothing. Compression is legitimate — but compression without a record of what was dropped means the loss becomes invisible and is never remediated. Method 4 is permitted **only** with documentation.

7.3 ນັກຮຽນທີ່ບໍ່ກັບມາ — Pupils who did not return

Within ten school days of reopening, the school shall identify **by name** every enrolled pupil who has not returned, establish the reason, and report to the DESB using Form SOP-07.

EVIDENCE

"Most returned, but some were late or absent for extra days." Respondents identified those living near the river, younger children, and dormitory residents on lower floors as worst affected. Flood-driven dropout is invisible unless someone counts by name.

7.4 ການສອບເສັງ — Examinations

Where a national examination is affected, PESS notifies MoES within forty-eight hours. MoES determines whether to reschedule, provide a supplementary sitting, or apply an adjustment. **No school shall make this determination locally.**

PART 8

ການລາຍງານ
Reporting

8.1 ສາຍການລາຍງານ ແລະ ກຳນົດເວລາ — Reporting chain and deadlines

From	To	What	Deadline
Principal	DESB	Verbal notification	2 hours from suspension
Principal	DESB	Form SOP-04	24 hours
Principal	DESB	Daily situation report	Daily while suspended
Principal	DESB	Form SOP-05 (reopening)	48 hours from reopening
Principal	DESB	Form SOP-06 (recovery plan)	10 days from reopening
Principal	DESB	Form SOP-07 (non-returners)	10 school days
DESB	PESS	District consolidation	72 hours from last reopening
DESB	LESMIS	Closure record per school	7 days from reopening
PESS	MoES	Provincial consolidation	14 days
MoES	NDMO / MLSW	Sector summary	30 days

8.2 ແຜນເອກະສານເຫດການ — The DESB Flood Event File

The DESB shall maintain a **Flood Event File** per event, containing: the original warning; the Cascade Log; every Form SOP-04; daily reports; reopening forms; recovery plans; non-returner reports; and the LESMIS entry confirmation. Retained **five years**, in paper and electronic form.

EVIDENCE

One DESB held "an official notice on file" plus a chat history; the other held paper only. Both were asked whether closure data entered LESMIS. Both said no. The Flood Event File formalises what exists; Part 9 supplies what does not.

PART 9

ລະບົບ LESMIS — ຊ່ອງຂໍ້ມູນທີ່ຂາດຫາຍ

LESMIS — The Missing Fields

9.1 ຂໍ້ບົກຜ່ອງ — The defect

LESMIS records **permanent** school status, including dissolution (ຍຸບ), and records building condition on a three-point scale. It has:

- no field for temporary closure
- no field for closure reason
- no field for closure or reopening date
- no field for authorising officer
- no cause-of-damage coding — building condition describes the state, never the cause

Consequence: the Ministry cannot answer the question *"how many schools suspended classes due to flooding last year, and for how many days?"* The data does not exist at national level.

Of 676 records nationally classified sub-standard or dilapidated, only 2 mention flooding — and only in free-text remarks, which are not queryable. **Flooding is not absent from Lao schools. It is absent from the Lao school record.**

9.2 ຊ່ອງຂໍ້ມູນທີ່ຕ້ອງເພີ່ມ — Required fields

MoES, through the Education Statistics Centre, shall add the following to the school record:

#	Field	Type	Values	Mand.
L1	CLOSURE_EVENT_ID	Auto	System-generated	Y
L2	CLOSURE_START_DATE	Date	DD/MM/YYYY	Y
L3	CLOSURE_END_DATE	Date	DD/MM/YYYY	Y
L4	CLOSURE_DAYS_LOST	Integer	Scheduled instructional days only — system-calculated	Y
L5	CLOSURE_REASON	Code	01 Flood · 02 Storm · 03 Landslide · 04 Drought · 05 Fire · 06 Epidemic · 07 Structural · 08 Civil · 09 Other	Y
L6	CLOSURE_TYPE	Code	1 Full · 2 Partial · 3 Did not open	Y
L7	CLOSURE_AUTHORISED_BY	Code	1 Principal §4.3 · 2 DESB · 3 Art. 18 warning · 4 PESS · 5 MoES	Y
L8	WARNING_RECEIVED	Boolean	Y / N	Y
L9	WARNING_LEAD_TIME_HOURS	Decimal	Hours from warning to impact	If L8=Y
L10	PUPILS_AFFECTED	Integer	Enrolled pupils losing instruction	Y
L11	PUPILS_NOT_RETURNED	Integer	At 10 school days	Y
L12	DAMAGE_CAUSE	Code	Same list as L5	If damage
L13	RECOVERY_PLAN_STATUS	Code	0 None · 1 Drafted · 2 Endorsed · 3 Complete	If L4≥3
L14	REPORTED_BY	Text	DESB officer name	Y
L15	ENTRY_DATE	Date	System	Y

9.3 ຂໍ້ສັງເກດການອອກແບບ — Design notes

L4 counts scheduled instructional days only. One school reported "two weeks," another "15 days," another "three weeks almost a month." These are not comparable until weekends and holidays are excluded. L4 must be system-calculated from L2, L3 and the school calendar — never typed by hand.

L7 is the accountability field. It answers who decided. In the August 2026 event the honest answer for every school would have been code 1 — and that fact, invisible today, is the single most consequential finding in the dataset.

L8 and L9 are the performance indicators. Whether a warning arrived, and how early, are the two numbers that tell the Ministry whether the warning system is improving. Observed values ranged from **0.3 hours to 48 hours**, and in four of six cases no official warning arrived at all.

L12 must be separate from building condition. Condition and cause are different facts. A school may be dilapidated from age or from water; today LESMIS cannot distinguish them, so flood damage is structurally invisible in national statistics.

9.4 ຄວາມເປັນໄປໄດ້ — Feasibility

Both DESB officers were asked whether they could enter two additional fields — closure date and closure reason. One answered **"Yes, no obstacles."** The other proposed the reason code directly, unprompted. **The constraint is not district capacity. It is the absence of the field.**

9.5 ການສອດຄ່ອງກັບມາດຕະຖານສາກົນ — Alignment with international practice

UNESCO, through IIEP and the UIS and with NORCAP, Education Cannot Wait and Sida, operates an established workstream on **crisis-sensitive EMIS**, supporting ministries to adapt education information systems to identify, address and monitor the education needs of crisis-affected populations. The fields specified above bring LESMIS into line with that practice. This is not a Lao-specific innovation but the application of an existing international standard.

9.6 ມາດຕະການຊົ່ວຄາວ — Interim measure

Until L1–L15 are implemented, the DESB shall maintain a **manual closure register** (Annex F) in the specified format, so that no further flood season passes without a record, and so that data migrates cleanly once the fields exist.

PART 10

ການຄຸ້ມຄອງ, ການທົບທວນ ແລະ ວຽກທີ່ຄ້າງຄາ

Governance, Review and Outstanding Actions

10.1 ການທົບທວນປະຈຳປີ — Annual review

MoES shall review this SOP before **1 May** each year, considering: closure records from the preceding season; lead times achieved (L9); cascade test results; drill timings; and non-returner data (L11).

10.2 ການສ້າງຕັ້ງຄະນະກຳມະການຕາມມາດຕາ 52 — Establish the sector committee under Article 52

Recommended within twelve months. A standing MoES Disaster Management Committee would provide: a permanent secretariat for this SOP; a counterpart to NDMO at national level; authority to issue recovery instructions without ad hoc decision; and a budget line.

The comparative argument. The health sector operates a standing risk communication and community engagement function that moves instructions from national level to frontline facilities, and records facility disruption. Education does not. Both sectors are administered by the same State, in the same districts, under the same fiscal constraints. In August 2026 the same province that could not transmit a warning to a school *did* deploy disaster management officers to the district, convene multi-agency coordination with UNICEF and Save the Children, and process reports upward — demonstrating that capacity exists.

What is absent is standing institutional structure. **That is a design deficiency, and design deficiencies are corrigible by decision.**

10.3 ການເຊື່ອມໂຍງກັບ EW4All — Integration with Early Warnings for All

Lao PDR's Early Warnings for All roadmap (2024–2027) commits to universal early warning coverage. Schools are a **defined, enumerated, addressable population of 12,479 public institutions** with named responsible officers. They are the easiest population in the country to reach, and reaching them reaches every child in the country for six hours a day. MoES shall seek the formal inclusion of schools as designated warning recipients under the EW4All institutional pillar.

10.4 ວຽກທີ່ຕ້ອງດໍາເນີນ — Outstanding actions

#	Action	Owner	By
1	Issue this SOP by ministerial decision	Minister	—
2	Request DESB addition to Art. 18 distribution lists	MoES / Cabinet	30 days
3	Specify and cost LESMIS fields L1–L15	Education Statistics Centre	60 days
4	Complete Annex A risk register, all districts	PESS / DESB	90 days
5	Train all principals and DESB officers	PESS	120 days
6	First national cascade test	MoES / PESS / DESB	Before 1 May
7	Establish Art. 52 committee	Minister	12 months
8	Develop parallel SOPs — fire, epidemic, structural	MoES	18 months
9	Secure partner funding for L1–L15 and training	MoES	Concurrent

ສັດຖະມົນຕີ ກະຊວງສຶກສາທິການ ແລະ ກິລາ
Minister of Education and Sports

Signature and seal

ວັນທີ / Date:

ANNEX A

ລະດັບຄວາມສ່ຽງ ແລະ ບັນຊີໂຮງຮຽນ
School Exposure Tiers and District Register

A.1 Tier definitions

Tier	Criteria (any one)	Obligations
A — High	Within 200 m of a watercourse; or flooded twice or more in 10 years; or downstream of a dam; or on a floodplain; or access road floods	Full Part 2; drills twice yearly; priority in cascade
B — Moderate	200–1,000 m from a watercourse; or flooded once in 10 years; or any pupil route crosses a watercourse	Full Part 2; drill once yearly
C — Low	All others	§§2.1, 2.2, 2.3 and 2.6 only

Tiers are assigned by the DESB from Form SOP-01, reviewed annually, and recorded against the school's LESMIS identifier.

A.2 Luang Namtha Province — district frame

Luang Namtha Province comprises five districts: **Luang Namtha (Namtha), Sing, Long, Viengphoukha and Nalae**. The province lies within the Nam Tha basin, a tributary system of the Mekong, and experiences monsoon flooding between June and September. The August 2026 event affected schools in at least two districts confirmed by this research — Luang Namtha and Nalae — with documented suspensions of zero to twenty-one days.

A.3 Schools confirmed affected, August–September 2026

#	School	District	Tier	Warning quality	Days lost	Evidence
1	Samakkhi Secondary (ມສ ສາມັກຄີ)	Luang Namtha	A	Hearsay via social media; no signature	15	Adjacent to canal; water entered classrooms; 807 pupils, 66 teachers, M1–M7; 10 villages; flooded 2–3× in 10-year tenure; lead time ~6 h
2	Nateuy Secondary (ມສ ນາຕຸຍ)	Luang Namtha	A	DMH product via social media; no acknowledgement of any kind	15	~1 m from river; "everything inside the school was damaged"; 651 pupils (317 girls), 26 teachers; 14 villages, farthest 19 km; lead time 15–20 min
3	School 029	Nalae	A	Written document; DESB named; receipt confirmed	7	10 m from watercourse; water entered classrooms; 65 pupils, 5 teachers, pre-primary–P5; lead time 2 days ; believed immediately "because there was written documentation from above"
4	School 032	Nalae	B	Written document; District DM Committee named; receipt confirmed	0	30 m from watercourse ; flooding reached perimeter fence and kitchen garden only, not buildings ; 37 pupils; 1 village; lead time 5 hours ; held written flood plan naming who to telephone; designated safety focal person ; moved equipment upstairs; did not suspend classes ; reported in writing to DESB
5	Provincial Ethnic Boarding School (ສາມັນກິນນອນ ຊົນເຜົ່າ)	Luang Namtha	A	Observed water directly; no official message	~21	Boarding; ground-floor dormitory property lost; lead time ~4 h
6	School 002	Luang Namtha	A	Colleague and own observation	4	Dormitory ground floor affected
7	Phoula Lower Secondary (ມ.ຕົ້ນ ຟູລາ ລຳ)	Luang Namtha	TBC	—	—	Respondent did not complete; classification required

Read the two shaded columns together. The two schools that received a written warning bearing a named issuing authority, and that acknowledged receipt, lost **0 and 7** days. The four that did not lost **4, 15, 15 and approximately 21**. Both of the former are in Nalae; all four of the latter are in Luang Namtha district.

Total confirmed: **1,560+ pupils** across schools with enrolment data. **Not one of these closures appears in LESMIS.**

A.4 Register to be completed

The table above is **not** the district risk register. It records only schools reached by this research. The DESB shall complete Form SOP-01 for **every** school in all five districts and produce the full register within ninety days (Action 4).

Required columns: LESMIS ID · school name (Lao and English) · district · village · level · enrolment (total, female) · teachers · distance to watercourse (m) · flood history (years) · exposure tier · WFP names ×3 · mobile numbers ×3 · Assembly Point · villages served · farthest journey time · boarding (Y/N, numbers) · shelter designation (Y/N).

A.5 National extension

The same method applies nationally. MoES holds building-condition data for all **12,479** public schools through the School Block Grant assessment; **1,482** are recorded as sub-standard or dilapidated. Cross-referencing that set against the flood-exposure criteria at A.1 would produce a first national Tier A list without new fieldwork.

ARITHMETIC NOTE

$12,479 - 1,482 = 10,997$, i.e. 88.1% meeting standard, against a published figure of 87.9%. The 0.2-point difference implies a denominator difference internal to the assessment — most likely the treatment of the 25 temporary-site schools. **This should be confirmed with the Education Statistics Centre before the figures are used in any public document.**

ANNEX B

ແບບຟອມ

Forms SOP-01 to SOP-08

Form SOP-01 · School Flood Risk Assessment (annual, before 1 May)

School name LESMIS ID District

Village GPS if available

Level Enrolment total / female Teachers total / female

Boarding Y/N and numbers by floor

Distance to nearest watercourse (m) Name of watercourse

Elevation of lowest classroom above normal water level (m)

Flood years in last 10 Parts that flood first

Villages served Farthest village journey time Routes crossing water Y/N and where

Assembly Point and capacity Route to Assembly Point Shelter designation Y/N

WFP 1 name / mobile WFP 2 WFP 3

Exposure tier assigned Assessor / date DESB verification / date

.....

Form SOP-02 · Drill Record

Date Type Start time Time last pupil reached Assembly Point

Pupils participating / enrolled Staff participating Problems observed

Is achieved time within the district's minimum credible lead time? Corrective actions

Next drill date

Form SOP-03 · School Flood Plan (one page; to be posted)

WFP names and numbers ×3 Trigger table (§4.3 verbatim) · Assembly Point and route

Staff-to-class assignment Uncollected pupils Dormitory arrangements

Equipment and records — where and by whom

DESB number District DM number Village authority number

.....

Form SOP-04 · Suspension Decision Record ★ (the critical record)

School LESMIS ID Date Time decision made Alert level

Trigger code(s) applied

Decision type: ☐ Do not open ☐ Early release ☐ Shelter in place ☐ Evacuate to Assembly Point

Decision-maker name and role Authority basis: ☐ §4.3 ☐ DESB instruction ☐ Art. 18

warning

Warning received Y/N If Y — source time

..... **lead time**

Pupils on site Released Sheltered

Unaccounted for Staff on site

Site condition

Informed — teachers (time) parents DESB

..... village authority

Signature

Form SOP-05 · Reopening Record

School Closure start Closure end

Instructional days lost

Criteria R1–R10 — each met / waived with reason Inspection by

Pupils returning / enrolled Facilities not restored Support received

and from whom

Partial operation Y/N and detail Signature

Form SOP-06 · Recovery Plan

Days lost Subjects and hours affected by class Recovery method per §7.2

Schedule Staff required Additional cost

Learning outcomes deprioritised (mandatory if compression used)

Examination impact Endorsement (DESB / PESS) and date

Form SOP-07 · Non-Returning Pupils

One row per pupil: Name · Class · Sex · Village · Date last attended · Reason (family displaced / economic / route impassable / transferred / unknown / other) · Action taken · Outcome at 30 days

Form SOP-08 · Cascade Log (DESB)

Event

Warning received — date

time

source

level

text

Schools identified

Per school: name · channel 1 time · channel 2 time · **acknowledgement time** · acknowledged by

Non-responders at 60 min

Escalation at 90 min

Unreached

reported to District DM at

Officer

Signature

ANNEX C

ບັດຕັດສິນໃຈຂອງຜູ້ອຳນວຍການ
Principal's Decision Card

Print, laminate, and keep on the office wall.

1. ໂຈະການສອນບໍ່? / SUSPEND?

ຖ້າມີຂໍ້ໃດໜຶ່ງເປັນຈິງ → ໂຈະທັນທີ · **If ANY ONE is true → SUSPEND NOW**

- ☐ ຄຳເຕືອນໄພລະບຸໂຮງຮຽນ — Warning names the school [A1]
- ☐ ຫ້ອງການສຶກສາສັງ — DESB instructs [A2]
- ☐ ນ້ຳເຂົ້າອາຄານ — Water in a building [B1]
- ☐ ນ້ຳຂ້າມທາງ — Water across a route [B2]
- ☐ ນ້ຳຂຶ້ນເຖິງລະດັບອັນຕະລາຍ — Rise precedes flooding [B3]
- ☐ ຂົວ ຫຼື ທ່າຂ້າມໃຊ້ບໍ່ໄດ້ — Crossing impassable [B4]
- ☐ ເຂື່ອນປ່ອຍນ້ຳ — Dam release notified [C1]
- ☐ ຕົ້ນນ້ຳຖ້ວມແລ້ວ — Upstream flooded [C2]
- ☐ ນັບນັກຮຽນບໍ່ຄົບ — Cannot account for pupils [D1]

→ ບໍ່ຕ້ອງຂໍອະນຸຍາດ. ທ່ານມີສິດຕັດສິນໃຈແລ້ວ (§4.2)

→ **DO NOT ASK PERMISSION. You are pre-authorised.**

2. ເຮັດແນວໃດ? / WHICH ACTION?

ຍັງບໍ່ທັນເປີດຮຽນ
Before school opens

ຢ່າເປີດ — DO NOT OPEN

ທາງຍັງດີ
Routes passable

ປ່ອຍກັບບ້ານເປັນກຸ່ມ — EARLY RELEASE, in groups

ທາງນ້ຳຖ້ວມ
Routes flooded

ຢູ່ໂຮງຮຽນ ຫຼື ຂຶ້ນຈຸດຊຸງ — SHELTER or ASSEMBLY POINT
⚠ ຢ່າປ່ອຍນັກຮຽນອອກ — DO NOT send children out

3. ພາຍໃນ 30 ນາທີ / WITHIN 30 MINUTES

- ☐ ແຈ້ງທຸກຄົນ — Tell all teachers
- ☐ ແຈ້ງຜູ້ປົກຄອງ — Tell parents (Annex G)
- ☐ ແຈ້ງນາຍບ້ານ — Tell the village authority
- ☐ ນັບນັກຮຽນທຸກຄົນຕາມຊື່ — Account for pupils BY NAME

4. ພາຍໃນ 2 ຊົ່ວໂມງ / WITHIN 2 HOURS

- ☐ ໂທແຈ້ງຫ້ອງການສຶກສາເມືອງ — Telephone the DESB
(ແຈ້ງ, ບໍ່ແມ່ນຂໍອະນຸຍາດ) — Notify, do not ask

5. ພາຍໃນ 24 ຊົ່ວໂມງ / WITHIN 24 HOURS

- ☐ ປະກອບແບບຟອມ SOP-04 — Complete Form SOP-04

ຫ້ອງການສຶກສາເມືອງ / DESB

.....

ຄະນະຄຸ້ມຄອງໄພພິບັດເມືອງ / District DM

.....

ນາຍບ້ານ / Village authority

.....

ຈຸດລວມຕົວ / Assembly Point

.....

ANNEX D

ບັດຄູບະຈຳຫ້ອງ

Teacher's Classroom Card

Print, laminate, and keep inside the class register.

1. ຢູ່ກັບຫ້ອງຮຽນຂອງທ່ານ. ຢ່າໄປຫາຫ້ອງອື່ນ.

STAY WITH YOUR CLASS. Do not go to another room.

2. ນັບນັກຮຽນຕາມບັນຊີລາຍຊື່ — ບໍ່ແມ່ນນັບຫົວ.

Take the register BY NAME — not a head count.

3. ບອກນັກຮຽນດ້ວຍຄຳເວົ້າສະຫງົບ ແລະ ສັ້ນ: Tell the children, calmly and briefly:

"ນ້ຳຈະຖ້ວມ. ພວກເຮົາຈະໄປບ່ອນປອດໄພ. ຢູ່ນຳຄູ."

"There is a flood. We are going somewhere safe. Stay with me."

4. ເອົາໄປ: ບັນຊີລາຍຊື່ນັກຮຽນ. ປ່ອຍໄວ້: ທຸກຢ່າງອື່ນ.

TAKE: the class register. **LEAVE:** everything else.

5. ໄປຈຸດລວມຕົວຕາມເສັ້ນທາງທີ່ກຳນົດ. ນັບອີກເທື່ອໜຶ່ງ.

Go to the Assembly Point by the set route. **Take the register AGAIN on arrival.**

6. ລາຍງານຜູ້ອ້າງອາການ: ນັກຮຽນຄົບ ຫຼື ຂາດຜູ້ໃດ (ຕາມຊື່).

Report to the principal: present and missing, **BY NAME**.

7. ຢູ່ກັບນັກຮຽນຈົນກວ່າຜູ້ປົກຄອງມາຮັບ. ຢ່າປ່ອຍນັກຮຽນໄປຄົນດຽວ.

STAY with the children until parents collect them. **NEVER release a child alone.**

8. ມື້ທີ່ຈະການສອນ — ໝາຍໃນບັນຊີວ່າ "ຖ້ວມ / FLD". ຢ່າປະຫວ່າງເປົ່າ.

On every closure day mark the register "**ຖ້ວມ / FLD**". Do not leave it blank.

⚠ ຢ່າໃຫ້ນັກຮຽນຍ່າງຜ່ານນ້ຳເລີກເກີນຫົວເຂົ້າ. — **NEVER** let a child walk through water above the knee.

⚠ ນ້ຳໄຫຼແຮງ 15 ຊັງຕີແມັດ ກໍ່ພັດຄົນລົ້ມໄດ້. — 15 cm of moving water can knock a person down.

ANNEX E

ຂັ້ນຕອນການສົ່ງຕໍ່ຂອງທ້ອງຖານສຶກສາເມືອງ
DESB Cascade Procedure

Elapsed	Action	Detail
0–5 min	Log the warning	Form SOP-08: source · time · level · text
5–10 min	Identify affected schools	From the Annex A register. Tier A first, then B, then C
10–30 min	Transmit — two channels	(1) Telephone the WFP, person to person (2) Group message with named sender. Use Annex G text. Do not improvise.
30 min	Record acknowledgements	School · WFP name · time acknowledged
60 min	Telephone non-responders	Try all three WFP numbers in turn
90 min	Contact the village authority	Ask them to go to the school in person
120 min	Report to District DM Committee	Name the school · attempts made · request physical dispatch · record in Form SOP-08

Standing rule. A school that has not acknowledged is treated as **not warned**, and its pupils as **unprotected**, until contact is confirmed.

ANNEX F

ບັນຊີບັນທຶກການປິດໂຮງຮຽນ (ຊົ່ວຄາວ)
Interim Manual Closure Register

To be maintained by the DESB until LESMIS fields L1–L15 exist. One row per school per event.
Transmitted to PESS monthly and to the Education Statistics Centre at season end. **Column order matches L1–L15 so that migration is direct.**

Event ref	LESMIS ID	School	District	Village	Closure start	Closure end	Days lost	Reason code	
Closure type	Authorised by	Warning received	Lead time (h)	Pupils affected	Not returned at 10 days	Damage cause	Recovery status	Reported by	Date entered

ANNEX G

ຂໍ້ຄວາມມາດຕະຖານ

Standard Message Texts

Use verbatim. Do not compose new wording under pressure.

G.1 · DESB → School (Level 3 Warning)

ດ່ວນ — ຄຳເຕືອນໄພນ້ຳຖ້ວມ ລະດັບ 3

ຈາກ: ຫ້ອງການສຶກສາທິການ ແລະ ກິລາເມືອງ [] · ຜູ້ສົ່ງ [ຊື່, ຕຳແໜ່ງ]

ເຖິງ: ຜູ້ອຳນວຍການໂຮງຮຽນ [] · ວັນທີ [] ເວລາ []

ເນື້ອໃນ: ຄາດວ່ານ້ຳຈະຖ້ວມ [ເຂດ] ພາຍໃນ [] ຊົ່ວໂມງ.

ໃຫ້ໃຈການຮຽນການສອນ ແລະ ປະຕິບັດຕາມຂັ້ນຕອນ ພາກທີ 4.

ກະດຸນາຕອບກັບພາຍໃນ 30 ນາທີ: ຊື່ໂຮງຮຽນ, ຊື່ທ່ານ, ເວລາໄດ້ຮັບ, ການປະຕິບັດ.

ຕິດຕໍ່: [ເບີ]

URGENT — FLOOD WARNING LEVEL 3. From DESB [], sender [name, title]. To Principal, [school]. Date [] time []. Flooding expected in [area] within [] hours. **Suspend classes and apply Part 4. Acknowledge within 30 minutes:** school name, your name, time received, action taken. Contact: [number].

G.2 · School → Parents

ແຈ້ງການຈາກໂຮງຮຽນ []

ຍ້ອນໄພນ້ຳຖ້ວມ ໂຮງຮຽນຂອງພວກເຮົາ **ໃຈການຮຽນການສອນ** ແຕ່ວັນທີ [].

ກະດຸນາຢ່າສົ່ງລູກມາໂຮງຮຽນ.

ນັກຮຽນທີ່ຢູ່ໂຮງຮຽນແລ້ວ ຂໍໃຫ້ມາຮັບທີ່ [ສະຖານທີ່].

ນັກຮຽນທຸກຄົນປອດໄພ ແລະ ຢູ່ກັບຄູ.

ຢ່າໃຫ້ລູກຍ່າງຜ່ານນ້ຳ.

ພວກເຮົາຈະແຈ້ງວັນເປີດຮຽນຄືນທາງ [ຊ່ອງທາງ]. ຕິດຕໍ່: [ເບີຜູ້ອຳນວຍການ]

Notice from [school]. Due to flooding the school has **suspended classes** from [date]. **Please do not send your child to school.** Children already at school should be collected from [location]. All children are safe and with their teachers.

Do not let your child walk through floodwater. We will announce reopening via [channel]. Contact: [principal's number].

G.3 · Principal → DESB (two-hour notification)

ແຈ້ງການໃຈການຮຽນການສອນ

ໂຮງຮຽນ [] ລະຫັດ [] · ວັນທີ [] ເວລາຕັດສິນໃຈ []

ເງື່ອນໄຂທີ່ໃຊ້: [ລະຫັດ §4.3] · ການປະຕິບັດ: [ບໍ່ເປີດ / ບ່ອຍກັບ / ຢູ່ໂຮງຮຽນ / ຍ້າຍຈຸດສູງ]

ນັກຮຽນຢູ່ໂຮງຮຽນ [] · ນັບບໍ່ຄົບ [] · ສະພາບ: []

ຄາດວ່າຈະເປີດຄືນ: [] · ຄວາມຕ້ອງການ: []

Suspension notification. School [], LESMIS ID []. Date [], decision time []. Triggers applied: [§4.3 codes].

Action: [did not open / early release / shelter / evacuate]. Pupils on site []. **Unaccounted for [].** Site condition []. Expected reopening []. Needs [].

G.4 · School → Parents (reopening)

ໂຮງຮຽນ [] ຈະ ເປີດຮຽນຄືນ ໃນວັນທີ [].

ອາຄານໄດ້ຮັບການກວດກາ ແລະ ບອດໄພແລ້ວ. ນ້ຳດື່ມ ແລະ ຫ້ອງນ້ຳໃຊ້ໄດ້ປົກກະຕິ.

ຈະມີ ການສອນຊົດເຊີຍ ເລີ່ມແຕ່ວັນທີ [] — ລາຍລະອຽດຈະແຈ້ງໃຫ້ຊາບ.

ຖ້າລູກຂອງທ່ານຍັງກັບມາຮຽນບໍ່ໄດ້ ກະລຸນາແຈ້ງໂຮງຮຽນ.

*[School] will **reopen** on [date]. Buildings have been inspected and are safe. Drinking water and latrines are working. **Make-up classes** begin [date] — details to follow. If your child cannot yet return, please tell the school.*

ANNEX H

ແບບຈຳລອງຄວາມພ້ອມຂອງສະຖາບັນ

The MRCC Institutional Readiness Model

H.1 Purpose

The **Mandate–Role–Coordination–Capacity (MRCC)** model is the diagnostic used to identify why a protective decision chain fails, and therefore which remedy applies. It underpins the design of this SOP.

Its central claim: **failures of protective action in public institutions are routinely misdiagnosed as capacity failures when they are in fact mandate or coordination failures** — and the two require entirely different remedies. Capacity failures need money. Mandate failures need a signature.

H.2 The four elements

Element	Question	Failure signature	Remedy
M — Mandate	Is there a written instrument naming who must act, and on what trigger?	Officials act correctly but without authority, carrying personal risk	Legal instrument; decision; delegation
R — Role	Is a <i>named person</i> assigned, with an alternate, and do they know it?	"It depends on whoever sees it first"	Designation; job description; training
C — Coordination	Does information cross the organisational boundary, with acknowledgement?	Informal workarounds; shadow systems; unacknowledged messages	Protocol; cascade; mandatory acknowledgement
P — Capacity	Are there people, money, equipment and skills to execute?	Correct intent, insufficient means	Budget; staffing; equipment; training

H.3 Scoring rubric

Each element is scored 0–3; total 0–12.

Score	Meaning
0 — Absent	No instrument, no named person, no protocol, no resource
1 — Nominal	Exists on paper; not operative in practice
2 — Partial	Operative in some units or some of the time; inconsistent
3 — Operative	Consistently applied, documented, verifiable

Interpretation bands: 0–3 Non-functional · 4–6 Fragile · 7–9 Functional with gaps · 10–12 Institutionalised

H.4 Worked example — two districts, one province, one flood

The August 2026 event permits the model to be scored separately for two districts struck by the same hazard in the same week. This is the strongest available test, because it holds hazard, law, province, ministry and fiscal envelope constant.

Element	Luang Namtha	Nalae	Basis
Mandate	0	0	No instrument authorises a principal to suspend classes. All four principals relied on personal authority. This is a national defect, not a district one.
Role	0	3	Luang Namtha: "no specific officer — whoever sees or hears the warning first"; not on the distribution list. Nalae: "a formally designated duty assigned to a specific officer"; on the list; one school held a designated safety focal person.
Coordination	1	3	Luang Namtha: warnings via social media; one school reported "no acknowledgement or check of any kind." Nalae: written warning, named issuing authority, telephone plus document, receipt confirmed by both schools, non-responders followed up, written report returned.
Capacity	2	2	Both hold and update contact lists. Luang Namtha in fact reported a <i>faster</i> full-district contact time (30 min vs 2 h). Province deployed officers; multi-agency recovery convened.
TOTAL	3 / 12	8 / 12	Non-functional · Functional with gaps
OUTCOME	15 and 15 days lost	7 and 0 days lost	

H.5 What the scoring shows

First, capacity is not the discriminating variable. Both districts score 2. The district that lost thirty instructional days across two schools had the same contact lists, the same staffing, the same budget — and a faster cascade when it acted — as the district that lost seven.

Second, the difference lies entirely in Role and Coordination — 0 and 1 against 3 and 3. Both are established by administrative instrument: a designation letter, a distribution list, an acknowledgement requirement, a follow-up rule. None requires money.

Third, Mandate is 0 in both districts. Nalae's good practice was built despite the absence of a mandate, by officers who chose to work that way. It is therefore fragile — it depends on individuals and will not survive their transfer.

A five-point difference in institutional readiness, and roughly ten instructional days per school, currently rests on personnel rather than policy. That is precisely what a standing procedure converts into something durable.

Effect of issuing this SOP. Mandate rises from 0 to 3 nationally. Role and Coordination rise to 3 in every district, because the SOP requires what Nalae already does. Luang Namtha moves 3 → 11; Nalae moves 8 → 11. The marginal cost is a ministerial signature, a designation letter per office, and two days of training.

H.6 The cross-sector control

	Mandate	Role	Coordination	Capacity	Total
Health sector (indicative)	3	3	2–3	2	10–11
Education — Nalae	0	3	3	2	8
Education — Luang Namtha	0	0	1	2	3

Capacity is constant at 2 across all three. Everything that varies — and everything that predicts the outcome — sits in the three institutional columns. The difference between a school losing fifteen days and a school losing none is not what the State could afford. It is what the State had written down.

H.7 Relationship to the Protective Action Decision Model

MRCC is an **institutional** complement to the **individual** Protective Action Decision Model. PADM specifies the predecision processes that precede protective action; MRCC asks what must be true of the *organisation* for those processes to be possible at all.

PADM process	MRCC precondition	SOP clause
Reception	Coordination — the message physically arrives	§3.4, §3.5
Attention	Role — a named person whose duty is to attend	§2.1, §3.2
Comprehension	Coordination — standard wording, defined levels	§3.1, Annex G
Protective-action perception	Mandate — a defined, permitted action exists	§4.3, §4.4
Stakeholder-norm perception	Mandate + Role — it is known who is expected to act	§4.1, §4.2
Behavioural response	Capacity — the means to execute	Parts 2 and 5

PADM explains why a *person* does or does not act. MRCC explains why the *institution* did or did not put that person in a position to act. This SOP operationalises both.

ANNEX I

ແຜນທີ່ຜູ້ມີສ່ວນຮ່ວມ
Stakeholder Map and Responsibilities

I.1 Government

Body	Statutory role	Role under this SOP	Contact point
DMH (Dept. of Meteorology & Hydrology, MAE)	Forecasts and hydrological monitoring	Supplies forecast and flood-watch products; does not warn	National WFP
NDMO / MLSW	National disaster coordination	Receives 30-day sector summary; coordinates response	MoES focal point
Provincial Governor / District Chief	Art. 18 — issues warnings	Issues the warning; requested to add DESB to distribution list	Cabinet
PDMC / DDMC	Territorial disaster committees	DESB Deputy Head holds the education seat (Art. 54)	DESB Deputy Head
MoES — Planning Dept.	Sector policy	Owens this SOP; national WFP; annual review	Director
MoES — Education Statistics Centre	LESMIS	Implements fields L1–L15; receives season-end returns	Head
PESS	Provincial education	Provincial WFP; consolidates; endorses recovery beyond 10 days	Deputy Head
DESB	District education	District WFP; cascade; Flood Event File; LESMIS entry	Deputy Head
School	Institution	Suspension decision; pupil safety; source records	Principal (WFP 1)
Village authority	Local administration	Last-resort channel; assists with uncollected pupils	Village head
Ministry of Health	Health sector	Comparator and structural model for standing risk communication	—

I.2 Partners

Partner	Demonstrated contribution	Role under this SOP
UNICEF	Authorised district use of supplies; supported classroom cleaning and reopening (Aug–Sept 2026); operates a school-based sensor network linked to LESMIS; holds post-Yagi school damage assessment data	Recovery supplies; technical support to LESMIS fields; possible warning carriage via existing school connectivity
Save the Children	Active in the August 2026 response; Lao Safe School Project to January 2026; community EWS work in Ngoy District, Luang Prabang	School safety training; community-to-school warning linkage
World Bank	Learning and Equity Acceleration Project (40 priority districts); SE Asia Disaster Risk Management Project (Nam Ou basin)	Financing for LESMIS fields; priority: joint planning where both operations overlap
ADB	Education infrastructure; weather-resilient facility standards	School siting and design standards; Tier A relocation
BEQUAL / DFAT	Primary curriculum and teacher CPD to June 2026	DRR content in curriculum; teacher training channel
WHO	Risk communication support to MoH; multilingual radio in the September 2024 floods	Source of the structural model for Part 3
Lao Red Cross	Community preparedness; volunteer networks	Village-level support; assembly point assistance

COORDINATION PRIORITY

The single highest-value coordination action available: the World Bank's disaster risk management and education operations do not appear to plan jointly in districts where both are present. The disaster operation builds warning infrastructure; the education operation works with the Statistics Centre on monitoring. Fields L1–L15 sit precisely at their intersection and belong to neither. **MoES should raise this directly.**

ANNEX J

ຖານຂໍ້ມູນຫຼັກຖານ
Evidence Base and Verification Status

J.1 Field evidence

Source	N	Date	Location
Teacher questionnaire	5	10–11 Sept 2026	Luang Namtha; Nalae
Principal questionnaire	4	10–11 Sept 2026	Luang Namtha; Nalae
DESB questionnaire	2	11 Sept 2026	Luang Namtha; Nalae
Follow-up interviews	3	Sept 2026	Luang Namtha
Total respondents	11		2 districts · 7 schools

Event: flooding of 29–31 August 2026, Nam Tha basin. **Instrument:** bilingual Lao–English, administered via structured online form, verbal consent recorded as a required field on each response.

Consent. All respondents gave verbal consent, recorded on the instrument. The researcher additionally holds the consent of all participating stakeholders for the use of this data in research outputs and in policy documents derived from it, including this SOP.

J.2 Key figures

Figure	Value	Source
Shortest observed lead time	15–20 minutes	Principal, Nateuy
Longest observed lead time	2 days	Principal, School 029
Shortest suspension	0 days	Principal, School 032 (did not close)
Longest suspension	~21 days	Teacher, Provincial Ethnic Boarding School
Schools recording closure in LESMIS	0 of 7	All respondents
Respondents with any disaster training	0 of 11	All respondents
Schools holding flood drills	0 of 7	All respondents
Principals citing personal authority to decide	4 of 4	Principal questionnaire
Schools aware of any closure reporting form	0 of 4	Principal questionnaire
DESB offices on the official distribution list	1 of 2	DESB questionnaire
DESB offices with a designated receiving officer	1 of 2	DESB questionnaire
DESB offices systematically following up non-responders	1 of 2	DESB questionnaire
Public schools nationally	12,479	LESMIS / SBA
Sub-standard or dilapidated	1,482	LESMIS / SBA
Of those, mentioning flooding in remarks	2	LESMIS free text

J.3 The district comparison

Variable	Nalae (n=2 schools)	Luang Namtha (n=4 schools)
Written warning received	2 / 2	0 / 4
Named issuing authority on the warning	2 / 2	0 / 4
Receipt acknowledged	2 / 2	0 / 4
Written flood plan held	1 / 2	1 / 4
Designated safety focal person	1 / 2	0 / 4
Mean instructional days lost	3.5	~14

Interpretation. The variable separating the two groups is not exposure — School 032 sits 30 m from a watercourse and took water to its perimeter — nor enrolment, nor building condition. It is whether a warning arrived as a document, from a named authority, and was acknowledged.

CAUTION
Two schools per district cannot establish causation. Uncontrolled confounders include rainfall intensity by sub-catchment, floor elevation, and the personal experience of individual principals. The finding is offered as the central hypothesis that the national reporting fields at Part 9 are designed to test.

J.4 Literature

Design choices in this SOP are grounded in the following peer-reviewed work.

Source	Finding	Applied at
Samansiri et al., <i>Geosciences</i> , 2023	Structured review with interpretive structural modelling identified 24 critical failure factors in flood early warning and response systems, finding governance, leadership, finance, standard operating procedures and community engagement to be the dominant driving factors	The warrant for this document
Shrestha et al., <i>IJDRR</i> , 2021	Last-mile analysis in Nepal identified institutional failures — insufficient coordination, inadequate personnel, limited budget, unclear roles and responsibilities — as the barrier to warnings reaching the vulnerable	Annex H (MRCC categories)
Da Costa et al., <i>Progress in Disaster Science</i> , 2025	Municipal officials construct a structured "shadow system" to bridge generic national alerts and local operational need, concentrating interpretive responsibility without formal support	§3.6
Moisés et al., <i>Sustainability</i> , 2022	Namibia's FEWS found top-down, disintegrated and response-driven, with "roles undefined among institutions"	§3.2
Perera et al., <i>IJDRR</i> , 2020	Warnings frequently fail to translate into emergency response; gaps in institutional communication and collaboration identified as cross-cutting	Part 3
Anshuka et al., <i>IJDRS</i> , 2026	Timely warnings coupled with training substantially improve response; belief in the warning and flood velocity can undermine outcomes even when warnings are prompt	§2.4
Lindell & Perry, <i>Risk Analysis</i> , 2012	PADM identifies three critical predecision processes — reception, attention, comprehension — preceding all further processing	§3.5, Annex H.7
Heath et al., <i>Risk Analysis</i> , 2018	Perceptions of protective action and of stakeholder norms — but not threat perception — predicted protective action decisions	§4.6, Annex G
Sorensen et al., <i>J. Hazardous Materials</i> , 2002	Evacuate-versus-shelter decisions must be prepared in a planning context, with information pre-organised for rapid selection under time pressure	§4.3, Annex C
Poulos et al., <i>Transportation Research Part C</i> , 2018	Agent-based evacuation model validated against a real school drill in a tsunami inundation zone achieved 5.9% error on evacuation time	§2.4
Najmanová et al., <i>Fire Safety Journal</i> , 2023	Across 15 nursery-school drills, pre-movement behaviour was strongly shaped by instructions and routine; a quarter of children required physical assistance	§4.4, Annex D
Najafi et al., <i>Nature Communications</i> , 2024	High-resolution impact-based forecasting of the 2021 European summer flood demonstrated a 17-hour actionable lead time	§3.1 (benchmark)
UNESCO / IIEP / UIS	Established programme supporting ministries to adapt EMIS to monitor the education needs of crisis-affected populations (crisis-sensitive EMIS)	§9.5

J.5 Verification status

Claim	Status
Art. 18 vests warning issuance in territorial administrative heads	Verified against Law on Disaster Management No. 71/NA (2019)
Art. 52 is permissive as to sector committees	Verified ; MoES committee not established
Art. 54 provides DDMC composition	Verified ; basis for the education seat
LESMIS lacks temporary-closure fields	Verified against LESMIS structure and DESB testimony
12,479 public schools; 1,482 sub-standard	Verified against SBA data
87.9% vs 88.1% arithmetic	Contested — denominator query outstanding with the Statistics Centre
Luang Namtha comprises five districts	To be confirmed against current administrative divisions before issuance
Health sector scoring at Annex H.6	Indicative only — WHO / MoH interviews not yet conducted
Event dates 29–31 Aug 2026	Respondent-reported; to be confirmed against DMH records
School 032 recorded as 37 pupils and 37 teachers	Probable transcription error in the teacher field — confirm with the school before publication
School 032 warning issued in the name of the District Disaster Management Committee	Respondent-reported, and reported as a document seen directly. Obtain a copy. This is the only documented instance in the dataset of a named issuing authority reaching a school, and is the evidentiary anchor of §1.3
Nalae DESB is on the official Art. 18 distribution list	Respondent-reported. Confirm with the District Chief's office and obtain the list
District-level outcome difference (J.3)	Hypothesis — n=2 per district; confounders uncontrolled

NOTE

Items marked *to be confirmed* or *indicative* must be resolved before this document is formally submitted. They are flagged here rather than silently smoothed.

J.6 Limitations

- Small purposive sample in one province; six schools with outcome data
- Two of five teacher-questionnaire respondents did not complete beyond the screening question
- Self-reported, one to two weeks after the event; recall error likely on precise timings
- No pupil, parent or district-administration respondents
- Rainfall intensity by sub-catchment not controlled
- No direct observation of a live warning cascade

Findings illustrate mechanism and generate hypotheses; they do not establish national prevalence. **The SOP is designed so that its own reporting fields (L1–L15) generate the data needed to test these findings at national scale.**

END OF DOCUMENT

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From field research conducted in Luang Namtha Province, September 2026
Submitted for the consideration of the Ministry of Education and Sports, Lao PDR